Sourcing Execution & Accountability — Product Spec (current state)

DigitalPaani Hiring Management System · Founders Office · 19 October 2026

> **Document status:** reflects the system **as built on 19 October 2026**. Phases P0–P2 are built, tested and verified locally; the database schema is applied in production; the feature is **switched off** in production and the code is not yet deployed. P3 and P4 are specified here but not built. · **Owner:** Aaron Newton (Founders Office) · **Origin:** Mansi Jain's seed PRD · **Supersedes:** the 14 October 2026 design spec (whose "as built" notes are folded in below).

1. Summary

Every open role gets a **sourcing plan**: the channels the team will use, and dated **commitments** for each (publish the posting, brief the agencies, launch the referral push, hit the weekly outbound target). Recruiters confirm work with one click. HMS compares the plan with reality and raises a short list of **exceptions** — things that were promised and did not happen — each of which must be answered one of three ways: *catch up*, *change the plan*, or *genuine blocker*.

Sourcing is owned by the HR/Admin persona as a whole, never by an individual recruiter. Everyone in HR sees the same queue and can act on every plan. Leadership sees an exception-led section at the bottom of the Dashboard. Hiring Managers see a read-only view of their own roles. Nothing in the existing hiring workflow, SLA engine or dashboards changes, and the whole module can be switched off with one environment variable.

2. Problem and goals

Sourcing used to be reactive. When a role was thin, management reconstructed after the fact which channels had been used, why follow-ups slipped and what had been promised. The Hiring SOP states expectations — activate channels within one working day of approval; at least five qualified candidates a week for each open P0/P1 role; the Hiring Manager steps in after five working days short — but nothing enforced or even measured them.

For any role, without chasing anyone, the module answers:

1. What was the sourcing strategy, and what did we commit to?
2. What has actually been done, and what remains?
3. Where is execution or effectiveness falling short, and what corrective action is required?

It is an **execution-management layer**, not another candidate-pipeline dashboard. Recruiters must never spend more time reporting than doing.

Success measures: share of open roles with an active plan · on-time completion of commitments · time to resolve exceptions · fewer roles reaching "low pipeline" without a visible, owned corrective action.

3. Design rules (Aaron's brief)

1. Research and refine the seed PRD rather than transcribe it.
2. Reuse existing HMS workflows (roles, My Tasks, the dashboard, the Gmail service).
3. Never disrupt what exists: the SLA engine, `pending_actions`, the main dashboard payload, Source quality and `candidates.source` are untouched.
4. Use free external APIs where they genuinely exist (only the Google Workspace APIs HMS already holds qualify).
5. Make sourcing simpler and actionable: one queue, one card per role, six exception types.
6. Dashboard additions go **below** the existing modules.

4. Decisions on record

Decision	By / when
"Qualified candidate" = shortlisted by a person **or** ResumeIQ score above 60, always shown as its two parts, switchable by a setting	Aaron, Oct 2026
Outbound prospect work stays in Google Sheets; HMS pulls via the Sheets API (P4)	Aaron, Oct 2026
HMS sends templated outreach directly from the owner's mailbox from day one, with guardrails (P4)	Aaron, Oct 2026
Hiring Manager view is **partly** redacted by design: a channel's excluded reason and an exception's resolution path and dates stay visible	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
Dashboard shows a "couldn't load" card until the backend is deployed — accepted	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
Channels are managed on the plan, with Add channel, Bring back, Undo skip and Edit strategy note; a channel added mid-flight starts its own first task	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
No "take down the postings" task when a role closes — removed with every workflow around it	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
Ownership is the HR persona, not individuals ("no segregation of HRs for sourcing")	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
Public holidays are not modelled; working days are Monday–Friday	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
E-mail digests stay **off**	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
Stay on Vercel Hobby as is; leave the dormant e-mail-digest cron alone	Aaron, 19 Oct 2026
The Google Form change (the "How did you hear about this role?" dropdown) is **optional** — it only improves channel attribution	19 Oct 2026

5. Who can do what

Persona	Sourcing capabilities
HR / Admin (`hr_recruiter`)	Everything, on every plan: activate plans, mark tasks done, skip and undo, add or bring back channels, edit the strategy note, resolve exceptions. Has the **Sourcing box in My Tasks**.
Super Admin	The same as HR/Admin on every plan, plus the Sourcing box. Changes thresholds in settings together with Leadership.
Leadership	The same write rights as HR (Leadership is HR-tier); reads the dashboard section; changes sourcing settings. Has no Sourcing box in My Tasks (that box stays alerts-only by design).
Hiring Manager	A **read-only view of their own roles** (matched by name, including a role with several Hiring Managers): plan structure, status, dates and counts. No strategy note, baseline, history, links, completion notes, exception reasons or provisional signals. Still included, on purpose: a channel's excluded reason and an exception's resolution path, snooze date and blocker date. A Hiring Manager of another role gets nothing.

No individual owner. A plan carries no owner field in the product: activation asks for none; the card shows "Owner: HR"; every HR user sees the identical My Tasks queue (there is no "mine" and no "everyone" switch); the dashboard table has no owner column. The one named person that remains is the **blocker owner** — who must unblock a blocked exception — chosen from the list of active people.

6. Core model

- **Plan** — one per role. Status `draft`, `active`, `paused` or `closed`; a strategy note; a **baseline** frozen at activation so the original commitment survives later edits; a change history. A draft is created automatically for every open role (on Approval, by a one-off backfill, and whenever a role is opened on the plan page). A draft is not tracked: it raises only "plan not activated". **Activation is the commitment moment.**
- **Channel** — `LinkedIn` and `Naukri/IIMjobs` (portals), `Agency`, `Internal Referral`, `Direct Outreach`. A channel is `planned` (not live yet), `active` (live) or `excluded` (not used, with a written reason).
- **Commitment** — a dated task on a channel, with a rolling due date (last done + cadence). It becomes overdue only after its due **day** ends (IST). Completing it records who and when, optional evidence, and rolls recurring tasks forward.
- **Evidence** — a link, a count, a note or an attestation, labelled *self-reported* or *auto* (reserved for later phases where HMS sees the work itself).
- **Exception** — a detected gap between plan and reality, with plain-language "what was committed / what happened / next action". At most one live exception per (role, channel, type).
- The role's **priority, openings and dates are read from the role**, never copied. The Close Target is not used for urgency.

6.1 Working days and dates

All dates are India Standard Time. **Working days are Monday to Friday; public holidays are not modelled** — a task that falls due on a holiday is simply due that day. Due dates are anchored to the **activation date** (never to an old approval date), so activating a plan for an existing role cannot create an instant overdue pile.

6.2 Commitment templates

When	Commitment	Due
Plan activated — portals	Publish the posting on LinkedIn / Naukri	1 working day after activation
Plan activated — Agency	Select agencies and share the role brief	2 working days
Plan activated — Internal Referral	Launch the employee referral push	1 working day
Plan activated — Direct Outreach	Start outbound outreach and set the weekly contact target	2 working days
Activation task done — portals	Renew the posting before it expires (repeats every 30 days; due 3 days before expiry, counted from the posting's own date)	27 days after posting
Activation task done — Agency	Follow up with the briefed agencies (weekly)	7 days
Activation task done — Referral	Repost the role to employees	14 days
Activation task done — Outreach	Log this week's outbound contacts against the target (weekly; the first 4 weeks only record a baseline and raise nothing)	7 days

A follow-on task is created only when the activation task is completed, so a task never exists before the way to evidence it does. On the activation screen, a channel ticked **"Already running before today"** is recorded as done at once and its renewal clock starts from the posting's own date — turning a backlog into one click.

6.3 What "qualified" means

A candidate counts as qualified from the first moment they were **shortlisted by a person** (the first move out of "Applied and Screened") **or** scored **above 60** by ResumeIQ. Both parts are always shown separately, because a score above 60 is easy to reach. The setting `qualified_rule` (`either`, `shortlisted`, `scored`) tightens it without code. The count uses only immutable timestamps, so any past week can be rebuilt. The SOP target applies to open **P0/P1** roles only.

7. Plan lifecycle

7.1 Role status drives plan status

The plan is reconciled from the role's **new status** and the plan's **current status**, never from the path the role took. Saving the same status twice changes nothing.

Role becomes…	Plan: none	draft	active	paused	closed
Approved / Live – Sourcing	create a draft	stays	stays	resumes (every open due date moves out by the time paused)	returns to draft (re-activate it)
On Hold	—	stays	pauses (clocks stop)	stays	stays

Role becomes…	Plan: none	draft	active	paused	closed
Closed – Filled / Cancelled	—	closes	closes	closes	stays
Draft / Under Review	—	stays	stays	stays	stays

Closing skips every open commitment and resolves every live exception as "role closed". **Nothing is queued** — there is no take-down task; taking a posting down on the portal is the recruiter's own job and the plan does not track it. A role that is reopened returns to a draft plan and must be activated again; history is kept, and re-activating with "already running" brings the skipped follow-ons back.

7.2 Managing a running plan

On an **active or paused** plan, HR-tier users have these controls on the role's Sourcing card (a draft chooses its channels at activation; a closed plan is finished; a Hiring Manager sees none):

Control	What it does
Add channel	Adds a channel that is not in the plan. Its first task falls due in 1–2 working days from today (on a paused plan, 1–2 working days after the role is back on). Adding a channel already in the plan is refused.
Bring back	Restores a channel that was left out, showing the earlier reason. Completing its first task again brings its follow-ons back with fresh dates; ones already running are left alone.
Undo skip	Reopens a skipped task: a skipped follow-up is due tomorrow, a skipped first task gets its normal 1–2 working days. Not offered for a channel that is left out.
Stop using	Leaves a channel out, with a required reason; its open tasks are skipped.
Edit strategy note	The note HR sees on the card; every change is written to the plan history.

Rules enforced by the server: a task that was skipped, or belongs to a channel that is left out or a closed plan, cannot be marked done; a plan can be activated only while it is a draft; every action on a task takes the plan's lock first, so two people acting at once can neither deadlock nor leave open work on a closed plan or a left-out channel.

Recruitment Mode. The role's own "Recruitment Mode" field is read-only on the role page once a plan exists; the plan is authoritative and mirrors one way, into the role, through the audited role edit. A channel added to the role by any other route joins the plan with its first task; one removed there is left out (the automatic reason is matched exactly, so a recruiter's own reason is never overridden).

8. The exception engine

Computed on read, idempotent and isolated: it uses its own tables, its own 3-minute throttle (called when the queue or dashboard is opened) and a daily cron, and never touches the SLA engine. Correctness comes from a database rule — at most one live exception per (plan, channel, type, key) across the open, snoozed and blocked states — not from the throttle.

Exception	Raised when	Live or provisional
Plan not activated	A role approved **after go-live** still has no active plan more than 1 working day later (existing roles appear in the "Plans to activate" list instead, so they can be rolled out in waves)	Live
Channel not live	A channel's first task is overdue	Live
Task overdue	Any other open task is past its due day (renewal, repost, weekly outbound)	Live
Follow-up overdue	The agency follow-up is overdue	Live
Not enough qualified candidates	An open P0/P1 role has fewer than 5 qualified in the rolling 7 days on **each** of the last 5 working days	**Provisional** until `shadow_until`
Blocker overdue	A recorded blocker's deadline has passed	Live

The overdue family rolls up to **one exception per channel at its worst state**. Severity = role priority (P0 40, P1 30, P2 20, P3 10) + days overdue (capped at 20) + 15 if the role is low on pipeline.

Shadow mode. The first time the engine runs enabled it stamps `go_live_date` = today and `shadow_until` = today + 42 days (never overwriting a value already there). Until then, threshold signals are *provisional*: shown to HR-tier users only (greyed, on the dashboard and the role card), no My Tasks item, no Hiring Manager view, never named in an e-mail, not resolvable. This exists because, with real data, 7 of 9 P0/P1 roles would have tripped the volume rule on day one. A draft plan's volume signal is always provisional.

8.1 Resolving an exception

Path	Needs	Effect
I'll catch up	A reason and a date within 14 days	Snoozed; it comes back if still true on that date
Change the plan	A reason; optionally "stop using this channel"	Closed, with the reason recorded in the plan history
I'm blocked	A reason, who must unblock it, and a deadline within 60 days	Parked as blocked; raises "blocker overdue" if the deadline passes

Provisional signals cannot be resolved. System facts and the recruiter's stated cause are stored separately.

9. Where it appears

1. **Role page → Sourcing card** (between Pipeline and Activity) and a header chip ("Sourcing on track", "Sourcing: 2 issues", "Sourcing paused", "Sourcing plan not activated"). The card shows the plan state and "Owner: HR", the volume gauge with both qualified parts, "Needs attention" exceptions, each channel with its tasks and evidence badges, applications by source, and the plan history.
2. **My Tasks → Sourcing** (HR/Admin and Super Admin): plans to activate, tasks due today, open exceptions grouped by role (top 5 and "show N more"), a count of those catching up or blocked, and this week's volume against target. One shared queue for all of HR.
3. **Dashboard → Sourcing execution** — the **last** section, after Operational velocity: a one-line summary (active plans / open roles, on-time % over 14 days, overdue count, open exceptions by priority) and an exceptions table (top 10, "show all") with *committed / what happened / next action / age*. Hiring Managers see only their own roles, without provisional rows or blocker dates.

4. **E-mails** (internal only, from hr@, **off by default**): one daily note to all active HR/Admin users when something needs doing (weekdays), and a Monday summary to the configured leadership addresses. Each kind is claimed for the day first, so a retried cron cannot send twice.

10. Attribution (optional)

Today every Job Application Form applicant is stamped `LinkedIn` by the ingest, so **channel yield cannot be trusted**. The optional fix is a visible dropdown on the form, **"How did you hear about this role?"** (LinkedIn, Naukri/IIMjobs, Agency, Internal Referral, Direct Outreach, Other), mapped by the Apps Script to a `source_tag` and stored in `applications.sub_source`; untagged applicants are labelled "Not tagged". It is the applicant's own answer, so it is *claimed* attribution; sources with fewer than five applications are flagged "too few to judge". `candidates.source` and the existing Source quality figures are untouched.

This is optional. Without it the module works completely — plans, tasks, exceptions, the queue and the dashboard — and only the "Applications by source" table cannot say where applicants came from. If done: update the live Apps Script first (two edits; never paste the reference copy over it), enable the module, then add the dropdown.

11. Data model

Eight additive tables, all `CREATE … IF NOT EXISTS`, BIGSERIAL ids, row-level security on with no policies (the backend bypasses it; direct API access is blocked). No existing table changed.

Table	Holds
`sourcing_plans`	One per role: status, strategy note, baseline, activation / pause / close times
`sourcing_plan_channels`	Channel, state, excluded reason, config (posting link and date), targets
`sourcing_commitments`	Each task: kind, title, cadence, due, status, meta
`sourcing_commitment_log`	Append-only: who completed what, when, against which due date
`sourcing_evidence`	Evidence attached to a completion (self-reported or auto)
`sourcing_exceptions`	Detected gaps and how they were resolved (partial unique index over open / snoozed / blocked)
`sourcing_plan_changes`	Plan history: activation, channels added or left out, skips, strategy-note edits
`sourcing_settings`	Key/value settings and the "digest sent today" claims

`sourcing_plans.owner_user_id` and `sourcing_exceptions.owner_user_id` still exist in the schema but are **unused and always empty** (kept so no production migration is needed). Settings: `go_live_date`, `shadow_until`, `qualified_rule`, `portal_expiry_days` (30 / 30), `renew_lead_days` (3), `agency_followup_days` (7), `referral_repost_days` (14), `weekly_baseline_weeks` (4), `volume_min_qualified` (5), `volume_window_days` (7), `volume_gap_working_days` (5), `referral_audience_email`, `digest_recipients`, `daily_digest_enabled` (off).

12. API (`/api/sourcing`)

All routes answer `{ enabled: false }` (reads) or 503 (writes) while the module is off.

Route	Purpose	Who
`GET /status`	Is it on, plus the public settings	any signed-in user
`GET /plans/:roleId`	The plan view (seeds a missing draft for an open role)	HR-tier: full; the role's Hiring Manager: redacted; others: 403
`POST /plans/:planId/activate`	Activate a draft (channels, "already running", strategy note)	HR-tier
`PATCH /plans/:planId`	Edit the strategy note (an owner field is refused with 400)	HR-tier
`PUT /plans/:planId/channel`	Add, bring back or leave out a channel (channel in the body — `Naukri/IIMjobs` contains a slash)	HR-tier
`POST /commitments/:id/complete`, `/skip`, `/reopen`	Mark done, skip with a reason, undo a skip	HR-tier
`POST /exceptions/:id/resolve`	Catch up / change the plan / blocker	HR-tier
`GET /queue`	The shared My Tasks queue	HR-tier
`GET /people`	Who can be named as a blocker owner (never includes automation accounts)	HR-tier
`GET` / `PUT /settings`	Read (HR-tier); change (Leadership / Super Admin)	—
`GET /api/dashboard/sourcing`	The dashboard section	any signed-in user, role-locked for Hiring Managers
`GET` / `POST /api/cron/sourcing-check`	The daily engine run (cron secret)	Vercel Cron

13. Safety, non-disruption and rollout

- **One switch.** Without `SOURCING_ENABLED=true` on the backend the module is inert: reads say "disabled", writes are refused, the role hook runs no queries, the UI hides itself. **Rollback** = set it to false and redeploy (tables stay, inert); a guarded script removes them.
- **Hooks never break existing flows.** The sourcing hook on a role save runs after the save commits and before JD generation, has its own error handling and tolerates missing tables — proven by a test that renames a sourcing table and shows a role save still succeeds.
- **PII.** Plan payloads carry no candidate personal data, and the Hiring Manager view is redacted (see §5).
- **Production today.** The schema is applied in Supabase (migration `20261019025305`, eight empty tables, matching the repo exactly). The code was merged on 20 October (PR #9) and `SOURCING_ENABLED=true` was set on the production backend the same day, so the module is on; its go-live clock starts at the first real use and no plan is activated yet. Six production roles' Hiring Manager names were corrected to the users' full names on 19 October (R003, R005, R007, R012, R0015, R020) so the Hiring Manager rules match.
- **Go-live order.** Deploy the backend, then the frontend (the dashboard shows a "couldn't load" card until the backend is live); set the flag and redeploy; activate P0/P1 roles in waves, with R016 as a dry run. (Optional: the Google Form change in §10.)

- **Vercel Hobby** is non-commercial and allows one cron run a day; the engine therefore also runs whenever the queue or dashboard is opened. Staying on Hobby was a deliberate choice.

14. Quality

Backend unit tests (engine detectors, working days, templates, e-mail builders, the plan-transition table) — 129 tests across 7 files; frontend component tests (the card and its dialogs, the dashboard section, My Tasks) — 78 tests across 6 files; a 39-test integration suite against a real database (plan lifecycle, the engine and its concurrency, role-status chains, channel management, the no-owner rule, Hiring Manager redaction) and a browser suite for the screens. The whole local suite — 592 tests across the API, database, browser and smoke projects — passes with the module switched on, and the 34-test read-only smoke suite passes against the live production deployment. An independent review found and drove fixes for a deadlock between task actions and plan-level actions, a paused-plan date error and several silent re-opening paths; each fix has a test proven to fail without it.

15. Not built yet

Phase	Scope
P3 Automation	One-click **agency brief** and follow-up, and **referral push**, sent through Gmail with the message id captured as automatic evidence; channel effort-versus-output once attribution is reliable
P4 Outbound	Company lists and prospect tracking in Google Sheets pulled via the Sheets API (the sheet owns status and dates; HMS keeps a touch log so weekly activity can be rebuilt); coverage and output exceptions; **direct-send templated outreach** from the owner's mailbox with guardrails (recruiter-supplied email only, never hr@, reserve-then-send log, per-person daily cap, signed unsubscribe link, suppression list, kill switch, DPDP notice); a `/sourcing` page
Parked	Free job syndication (needs a public careers page), Cutshort, Brave search, GitHub search, Campus as a channel

Verified external options (14 October 2026). *Used:* Gmail send, Drive, Calendar and the Sheets API — all free and already held by HMS. *Do not build against:* LinkedIn's posting/apply APIs (partner and paid) and any scraping or reseller of LinkedIn, Naukri, Indeed, foundit, Apna, Hirist or Internshala; Google Custom Search and Bing Search (closed); the free tiers of contact-data vendors; polling job boards for liveness. **LinkedIn data stays human-entered.**

Compliance (P4). India's DPDP Rules were notified 13 November 2025; notice, consent, retention and erasure duties apply from **13 May 2027**. Hence: store only a name, a human-entered profile link, current employer and role, a recruiter-supplied email, source and dates; no scraped contact details; 12-month default retention for unconverted prospects; suppression honoured before every send; convert to an applicant record only when the person applies.

16. Open questions

1. Confirm the portal expiry and renewal cadence and the agency first-response time (both provisional).
2. The internal audience address for referral pushes (needed for P3).
3. Whether to enable the Sheets API in the GCP project and share the trackers with the service account (needed for P4).

4. After the first weeks of provisional data: is "shortlisted OR ResumeIQ above 60" still the right definition of qualified?

Appendix — What changed from the seed PRD, and why

Seed PRD	This product	Why
Channels chosen at plan time	Seeded from the role's existing Recruitment Mode; the plan is authoritative afterwards	The requisition already captures it; two pickers would drift
Exceptions as work items	Own tables and endpoint, computed on read	`pending_actions` would have inflated every HR user's badge and been swept by the SLA engine
7+ exception types	6, with threshold signals provisional first	7 of 9 P0/P1 roles would trip the rule on day one
Per-recruiter ownership	**HR persona owns every plan**	Aaron: no segregation of HRs for sourcing
Holiday calendar	Monday–Friday only	Aaron: the complexity is not needed
Take-down tracking on close	None	Aaron: not worth the complexity
Candidate source from existing fields	Optional form dropdown → application-level `sub_source`	Existing source data is wrong (every form applicant is `LinkedIn`)
Portal liveness tracking	Attested plus expected expiry; "unknown", never "closed"	No free API; scraping is prohibited
Leadership, HR and recruiter dashboards	An exceptions-led dashboard section, one My Tasks box, the role card	Avoid a wall of numbers